



THE RAMAYANA OF VALMIKI

Ayodhya Kanda

A Children's Illustrated Storybook · 30 Pages

BOOK TWO · THE BOOK OF AYODHYA

An original simplified retelling for children,
with detailed AI illustration prompts.

Based on the translation by Hari Prasad Shastri.

How to Use This Book

Each page has two parts:

- **Story Text for Kids** — 2–4 simple, magical sentences to read aloud.
- **AI Image Prompt** — a richly detailed prompt written for a **polished digital children's-book illustration** look, kept visually consistent from page to page, **full-bleed with no borders**.

This book follows the Bala Kanda storybook and leads into the Aranya Kanda. For best results, paste the **Master Style Block** (below) together with each page's prompt, or simply use each prompt as-is.

Master Style Block (for visual consistency)

Medium & style: Richly detailed **digital children's-storybook illustration**, in the style of a modern Illustrated Ramayana for Children cover — **semi-realistic yet softly stylized** characters with expressive friendly faces, large warm eyes and smooth skin; polished **digital painting** with gentle **cel-shading**, soft airbrushed gradients and crisp clean highlights; finely detailed costumes, fabrics and ornaments; **lush painterly backgrounds** with atmospheric depth and soft focus.

Lighting: warm **cinematic** directional light with a gentle glowing rim-light and soft ambient glow.

Colour: vibrant, saturated, harmonious — saffron, marigold gold, turquoise, rose-magenta, royal crimson, forest green and deep indigo.

Skin tones: Only **Rama** (and, where they appear, divine forms of **Vishnu** and **Shiva**) has gentle **blue/teal skin**; **every other character has a natural human skin tone** — warm golden-brown, fair or tawny — and is **never blue**. Vanaras (monkey-people) keep natural fur colours.

Costume: strictly **ancient, traditional Indian attire** — dhotis, angavastrams, draped saris, mukut crowns and traditional gold jewelry, bark-cloth and deerskin for forest-exiles, classical robes and armour — with **absolutely no modern clothing, fabrics, footwear or accessories**.

Composition: dynamic, **full-bleed, edge-to-edge, absolutely no border and no frame**. Aspect ratio 4:3 (use portrait 3:4 for a cover).

Character Reference Sheet (keep consistent on every page)

(Rama, Sita and Lakshmana begin in royal palace attire; from the day they leave for exile they wear simple ascetic bark-cloth and saffron, with hair in ascetic top-knots, keeping their noble bearing.)

- **Rama** — gentle prince, soft **blue/teal skin**, large kind eyes, calm half-smile; royal golden-yellow silk and jeweled crown at first, then simple saffron/bark-cloth and an ascetic top-knot in exile; carries a great bow. Serene and dutiful.
- **Sita** — radiant golden-brown complexion, jasmine in a long dark braid; rich red-and-gold royal sari, then a simple graceful ochre forest sari; gentle, loving, devoted.
- **Lakshmana** — fair golden-brown skin, alert and protective; saffron attire, bow always ready; ever at Rama's side.
- **Dasaratha** — aged noble king, grey beard, gentle eyes; cream-and-gold robes and a tall jeweled crown; often shown heartbroken.
- **Bharata** — Rama's noble younger brother (Kaikeyi's son), golden-brown skin, gentle earnest face; royal robes, later simple ascetic dress as a grieving, devoted regent.
- **Shatrughna** — the youngest brother, loyal companion of Bharata, princely attire.

- **Kaikeyi** — a beautiful young queen in fine silks and gold jewelry, proud and misled, her face torn between desire and doubt.
- **Manthara** — the hunchbacked maid, wizened and cunning with sharp scheming eyes, plain dark-red garments; sinister but kid-friendly, never grotesque.
- **Kaushalya** — Rama's gentle aged mother-queen, sorrowful kind face, elegant pale silks.
- **Sumantra** — the loyal old charioteer-minister, white beard, warm faithful face, simple noble dress.
- **Guha** — the kindly forest-tribe chief and boatman, sturdy and friendly, simple earthy garments, a small boat.

Page 1: A Joyful Decision

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

King Dasaratha had grown old, and his heart was full of love for his eldest son. "Rama is wise, brave, and kind," he declared. "Let him be crowned the young king of Ayodhya!" The whole court cheered, for everyone adored Prince Rama.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A grand, joyful royal court in the palace of Ayodhya, warm golden light streaming through tall arches. Aged **King Dasaratha** rises from his jeweled throne with a proud, loving smile, one hand raised in proclamation; before him stands noble **Rama** (blue skin, golden silk, jeweled crown) with humble grace, while ministers, elders and courtiers in colourful silks cheer with delighted faces and folded hands. Surroundings: ornate carved pillars, silk canopies, brass lamps, garlands, a marble floor with patterns. Emotions: pride, love, joyful celebration. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, ornate detailed court and costumes, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-crimson-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 2: Ayodhya Decorated for Celebration

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Wonderful news spread through the city: tomorrow Rama would be crowned! People hung garlands, lit lamps, and painted bright patterns on their doorsteps. All of Ayodhya sparkled with happiness and song.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A festive panoramic view of the golden city of **Ayodhya** at sunset, glowing with celebration. Citizens in bright clothing hang flower garlands and string up little oil-lamps, paint colourful *rangoli* on doorsteps, raise banners and dance in the streets; children scatter petals and musicians play. Surroundings: golden domes, temple spires, lotus ponds, decorated archways, a warm rosy sky with the first lamps twinkling. Emotions: joy, anticipation, festive warmth. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized crowds, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft glowing gradients, ornate detailed architecture and decorations, lush atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic sunset light with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-turquoise-magenta-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 3: Manthara's Wicked Whispers

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

But a jealous old maid named Manthara crept to Queen Kaikeyi's room. "Why should Rama be king?" she hissed. "Your own son Bharata should rule instead!" With clever, poisonous words, she filled the queen's heart with envy and fear.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A shadowy, intimate palace chamber lit by a single flickering lamp at night. The hunchbacked maid **Manthara** — wizened, sharp-eyed, plain dark-red garments — leans close with a cunning, scheming whisper and a pointing finger; beautiful **Queen Kaikeyi**, in fine silks and gold jewelry, listens with a troubled, slowly darkening expression, doubt creeping into her face. Surroundings: silk curtains, carved screens, deep warm shadows, an ornate mirror and jewel-boxes, a tense uneasy mood. Emotions: jealousy, scheming, dawning temptation. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, kid-friendly not grotesque, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, moody warm gradients, detailed fabrics, atmospheric depth with soft focus, dramatic low cinematic lamplight with rim-glow; rich saturated colours (deep-crimson-indigo-amber). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 4: Kaikeyi's Cruel Demand

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Long ago, the king had promised Kaikeyi two wishes, and now she demanded them. "Make Bharata the king," she said coldly, "and send Rama away to the forest for fourteen years!" The king could hardly believe her cruel words.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A tense, dramatic palace chamber in dim, cold-toned light. **Queen Kaikeyi**, having cast off her jewels and let down her hair in protest, sits rigid and proud upon the floor, demanding her two boons with a hard, determined face and an outstretched hand. Before her, aged **King Dasaratha** recoils in shock and disbelief, one hand to his heart, his face stricken. Surroundings: scattered ornaments, dim chamber, long shadows, a chill blue-grey mood. Emotions: cold resolve, shock, heartbreak beginning. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, moody cool gradients, detailed silks, atmospheric depth with soft focus, dramatic cinematic light with subtle rim-glow; rich saturated colours (cold-indigo-crimson-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 5: The King's Heartbreak

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

King Dasaratha begged and wept, for he loved Rama more than his own life. But a king must always keep his promise, and Kaikeyi would not change her mind. Trapped by his own given word, the old king collapsed in sorrow.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A heartbreaking palace scene in dim golden lamplight. Aged **King Dasaratha** sinks down upon a couch, face buried in his hands, tears streaming, utterly broken with grief; nearby stands **Queen Kaikeyi**, unmoved and stern. A faithful attendant looks

on, helpless and sorrowful. Surroundings: a vast shadowy royal chamber, a dimmed lamp, heavy silk drapes, an oppressive sorrowful hush. Emotions: anguish, helplessness, the weight of a promise. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with deeply expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft moody gradients, detailed robes, atmospheric depth with soft focus, sombre cinematic lamplight with gentle rim-glow; rich saturated colours (sombre-amber-indigo-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 6: Rama Accepts with a Calm Heart

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

When Rama heard the news, he did not weep or argue. "If this is my father's word, I will gladly obey," he said with a calm and gentle smile. To Rama, keeping a promise and honouring his father were the most important things of all.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A serene, noble palace scene in soft light. Young **Rama** (blue skin, royal silks) stands tall and utterly calm, a peaceful, accepting smile on his gentle face, one hand raised reassuringly; before him his heartbroken **father Dasaratha** and a stern **Kaikeyi** watch — the king amazed at Rama's grace. Courtiers in the background gaze in sorrowful wonder. Surroundings: pillared hall, soft beams of light, garlands now drooping, a quiet dignified mood. Emotions: serene acceptance, duty, quiet strength, awe. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed costumes, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm gentle cinematic light with rim-glow on Rama; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-gold-cream). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 7: Telling Mother Kaushalya

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Rama went gently to his mother, Queen Kaushalya, to share the sad news. She wept to lose her beloved son for fourteen long years. But Rama comforted her tenderly: "Do not grieve, Mother; goodness and duty will keep me safe."

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A tender, emotional chamber scene in warm soft light. Gentle **Queen Kaushalya** (aged, elegant pale silks, kind sorrowful face) clings to **Rama's** hands, tears on her cheeks; **Rama** kneels beside her, comforting her with a loving, reassuring smile and a gentle touch. Surroundings: a serene private chamber, a small shrine with a lamp, soft drapes, flowers, a hushed loving mood. Emotions: a mother's sorrow, tender comfort, devotion. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with warm expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft glowing gradients, detailed silks, intimate atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (rose-saffron-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 8: Sita Will Not Stay Behind

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Rama asked his beloved Sita to remain safely in the palace, but she would not hear of it. "A wife belongs beside her husband," she said bravely. "Wherever you go, my place is with you — even into the wild forest."

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A loving, resolute palace scene. **Rama** (gentle, concerned) gently tries to persuade **Sita** to stay, a hand raised softly; but **Sita** (golden-brown, royal red-and-gold sari, jasmine in her braid) stands devoted and determined, both hands clasped to her heart, her face full of loving courage and quiet firmness. Surroundings: an ornate chamber opening to a garden, soft daylight, flowers, a sense of brave devotion. Emotions: love, courage, devotion, gentle insistence. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed sari and jewelry, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (magenta-saffron-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 9: Loyal Lakshmana Joins

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Then faithful Lakshmana stepped forward, bow in hand. "Brother, I will come too, to serve you and protect you both," he declared. With loving loyalty, he chose the hardship of the forest over comfort at home.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A warm, determined scene. Devoted **Lakshmana** (fair golden-brown skin) kneels before **Rama** with one hand on his bow and earnest, loyal eyes, vowing to follow; **Rama** places a grateful, loving hand on his brother's shoulder, and **Sita** stands beside them. Surroundings: a palace threshold opening to the world outside, soft light, a sense of brotherhood and resolve. Emotions: loyalty, brotherly love, brave devotion. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed costumes and bow, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-gold-turquoise). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 10: Giving Away Their Riches

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Before leaving, Rama, Sita, and Lakshmana gave away all their gold, jewels, and fine clothes to the poor, to brahmins, and to faithful servants. They kept nothing for themselves but their courage and their love. Then they put on simple robes of bark and saffron.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A touching, generous courtyard scene in warm light. **Rama, Sita** and **Lakshmana**, now changing into simple saffron-and-bark-cloth garments, lovingly hand out trays of gold coins, jewels, fine silks and cows to grateful brahmins, poor families and servants who bow with thankful, moved faces. Surroundings: a sunlit palace courtyard, heaped gifts, fluttering doves, soft beams of light, an air of selfless giving. Emotions: generosity, humility, gratitude, selflessness. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly

stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed treasures and robes, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-gold-emerald). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 11: The Sorrowful Farewell

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

The whole palace wept as the three set out in Sumantra's chariot. King Dasaratha reached out his arms, longing to keep his son. But Rama bowed lovingly to his father, climbed aboard, and the chariot rolled toward the forest.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A deeply emotional farewell at the grand palace gates. **Rama, Sita** and **Lakshmana** (now in simple saffron exile dress) stand in a fine chariot driven by the white-bearded charioteer **Sumantra**; aged **King Dasaratha** stretches out trembling arms with a tear-streaked, anguished face, held back by attendants, while queens and crowds weep all around. Surroundings: ornate palace gateway, drooping garlands, a dusty road leading away, soft sorrowful light. Emotions: heartbreak, longing, brave farewell. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with deeply expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft sorrowful gradients, detailed chariot and costumes, atmospheric depth with soft focus, tender cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; rich saturated colours (sombre-saffron-amber-grey). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 12: All Ayodhya Weeps

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

The people of Ayodhya loved Rama so dearly that many ran after his chariot, crying for him to stay. The whole city felt empty and grey without their beloved prince. Even the rivers and gardens seemed to mourn.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A poignant, sweeping scene of the people of **Ayodhya** chasing after Rama's distant chariot down a long road at dusk, arms outstretched, faces full of love and sorrow, some children running, some elders weeping. In the background the golden city looks dim and lonely under a fading sky. Surroundings: a dusty road, scattered dropped flowers, willows drooping by a river, soft melancholy light. Emotions: love, longing, collective grief. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized crowd, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft moody gradients, atmospheric depth with soft focus, melancholy cinematic dusk light with gentle rim-glow; rich saturated colours (dusky-amber-indigo-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 13: Guha the Kind Boatman

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

At the great river Ganga, they met Guha, the friendly chief of the forest boatmen of Shringaverapura, who loved Rama like a brother. He welcomed them warmly and ferried them across the holy river in his boat. Even in the wilderness, kindness was waiting for them.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A serene riverside scene at the sacred **Ganga** in soft golden light. The sturdy, friendly forest-chief **Guha**, in simple earthy garments, greets **Rama**, **Sita** and **Lakshmana** warmly with folded hands and a broad smile, gesturing toward his wooden boat at the water's edge. Surroundings: a wide shimmering river, reed banks, lotus blooms, herons, distant green forest, a soft sunrise glow. Emotions: warmth, friendship, simple kindness. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with warm faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed boat and riverbank, lush atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (turquoise-saffron-green-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 14: Farewell to Sumantra

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

On the far bank, Rama gently told the loyal charioteer Sumantra to return home to Ayodhya. With a heavy heart, the old minister said goodbye, carrying their love back to the grieving king. The three travellers walked on, deeper into the wild.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A tender parting on the far riverbank in soft morning light. The white-bearded charioteer **Sumantra**, tears in his faithful eyes, bows reluctantly to **Rama**, who gives a gentle blessing and a comforting hand; the empty chariot and horses wait to turn back. **Sita** and **Lakshmana** stand ready to walk on toward the green forest. Surroundings: the shining river behind, a forest path ahead, soft light, a bittersweet mood. Emotions: faithful sorrow, gentle farewell, quiet resolve. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed chariot and robes, atmospheric depth with soft focus, gentle cinematic morning light with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-green-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 15: The Hermitage of Bharadwaja

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Travelling on, they came to the peaceful hermitage of the wise sage Bharadwaja at Prayaga, where the holy rivers Ganga and Yamuna meet. He welcomed the exiles with fruit and blessings and showed them the way ahead. "Go to the lovely hill of Chitrakuta," he advised, "and make your home there."

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A tranquil riverside hermitage at the meeting of two rivers (Prayaga), in warm dappled light. The serene elderly sage **Bharadwaja** (white beard, saffron robes, glowing aura) welcomes **Rama**, **Sita** and **Lakshmana** with a basket of fruit and a kindly blessing, pointing toward distant green hills. Surroundings: thatched ashram huts, sacred fire, blossoming trees, deer, two shining rivers merging, soft golden light. Emotions: peace, welcome, gentle guidance. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed hermitage and foliage, lush atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (emerald-saffron-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 16: A New Home at Chitrakuta

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

On the beautiful hill of Chitrakuta, beside the sparkling Mandakini stream, Lakshmana built a snug little hut of leaves and wood. Surrounded by flowers, deer, and birdsong, the three made a happy, simple home. For a while, the forest felt peaceful and kind.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

An idyllic forest-hill scene at **Chitrakuta** in golden light. A charming leaf-and-wood hut nestles among flowering trees beside a sparkling brook; **Lakshmana** finishes the thatched roof, **Sita** tends blossoms and feeds gentle spotted deer, and **Rama** sits content with his bow, all with peaceful, happy faces. Surroundings: green hills, waterfalls, peacocks, butterflies, soft mist, dappled sunbeams. Emotions: contentment, simple joy, harmony with nature. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft warm gradients, detailed hut and foliage, lush atmospheric hill depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (emerald-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 17: The King's Last Sorrow

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Back in Ayodhya, King Dasaratha could not bear the loss of his beloved Rama. His heart, heavy with sorrow and his old broken promise, grew weaker and weaker. Calling out Rama's name, the gentle old king closed his eyes forever.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A solemn, tender palace chamber at twilight, lit by soft lamp-glow. Aged **King Dasaratha** lies peacefully upon a silk-draped royal couch, one hand reaching weakly toward an unseen distance as he whispers his son's name, his face gentle in his final sorrow; **Queen Kaushalya** and a faithful attendant weep softly at his side. A soft glow suggests his spirit gently departing (handled tenderly, not frightening). Surroundings: dim ornate chamber, a flickering lamp, drawn drapes, a hushed reverent mood. Emotions: sorrow, love, peaceful passing. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with gentle expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft sombre gradients, detailed silks, atmospheric depth with soft focus, tender cinematic lamplight with soft rim-glow; rich saturated colours (sombre-amber-indigo-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 18: Bharata Is Called Home

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Prince Bharata, who had been far away visiting his grandfather in the Kekaya kingdom, was hurried home by swift messengers. He did not yet know of his father's death or his brother's exile. With a worried heart, he rushed back to Ayodhya.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A scene of urgent travel across the countryside at dawn. Noble young **Bharata** (golden-brown skin, princely robes, earnest worried face) rides swiftly in a chariot or on horseback beside his brother **Shatrughna** and royal messengers, hurrying along a

long road toward distant Ayodhya. Surroundings: rolling fields, a pale anxious dawn sky, wind-tossed banners, dust of haste, the faint city on the horizon. Emotions: worry, urgency, foreboding. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed regalia, atmospheric landscape depth with soft focus, cool cinematic dawn light with rim-glow; rich saturated colours (cool-amber-green-grey). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 19: Bharata Refuses the Throne

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

When Bharata learned what his mother had done, he was heartbroken and furious. "I never wanted the throne!" he cried. "You have wronged my noble brother Rama, and I will not take what is his." Bharata's love and honesty shone bright as gold.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A dramatic, emotional palace chamber. Noble **Bharata**, his face full of grief and righteous anger, turns away from an empty throne with a refusing gesture, tears in his eyes, confronting his mother **Kaikeyi**, who looks startled and ashamed. Surroundings: a grand but gloomy throne hall, a vacant jeweled throne in shadow, dim light, a heavy emotional mood. Emotions: heartbreak, honesty, righteous refusal, integrity. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with deeply expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, moody gradients, detailed robes and throne, atmospheric depth with soft focus, dramatic cinematic light with gentle rim-glow on Bharata; rich saturated colours (sombre-crimson-indigo-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 20: A Son's Farewell to His Father

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

With deep love and sorrow, Bharata and his brothers performed the sacred final rites for their dear father, King Dasaratha. They honoured him with prayers, fire, and the holy river's waters. Their tears fell, but their love gave the old king a peaceful farewell.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A solemn, reverent riverside ceremony at soft dawn. **Bharata** and **Shatrughna**, in simple white mourning cloth, perform the sacred funeral rites beside a gently glowing sacred fire and the holy river, sages chanting around them with folded hands; their faces are sorrowful yet devoted. Surroundings: a calm river, rising sacred smoke, white flowers, brass vessels, soft misty light, a hushed dignified mood. Emotions: grief, love, sacred farewell, devotion. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with gentle expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed ritual and river, atmospheric depth with soft focus, gentle cinematic dawn light with soft rim-glow; rich saturated colours (soft-white-saffron-amber-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 21: Bharata Sets Out to Bring Rama Home

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Bharata could not rest while his brother lived in the forest. "I will go to Rama and beg him to come home and be our king," he decided. So he set off toward Chitrakuta with the whole army, the ministers, and even the queen-mothers.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A grand, hopeful procession winding through the countryside toward forested hills. Noble **Bharata**, now in simple humble dress, leads on foot or in a chariot at the front, his face earnest and determined; behind him stretch the royal army, elephants, ministers, sages and the queen-mothers in palanquins, banners waving. Surroundings: rolling green hills, a long road toward misty mountains (Chitrakuta), bright daylight, dust of the great march. Emotions: determination, brotherly love, hope. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters and elephants, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed army and regalia, lush atmospheric landscape depth with soft focus, bright cinematic light with rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-green-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 22: The Brothers Reunite

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

When the brothers saw each other at Chitrakuta, they ran together and embraced, weeping with both joy and sorrow. Rama gently asked about their father — and Bharata had to share the heartbreaking news of the old king's passing. They held each other close in their grief.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A deeply emotional reunion in a sunlit forest clearing at Chitrakuta. **Rama** (in saffron exile dress) and **Bharata** embrace tightly, both faces streaming with tears of joy and sorrow; **Lakshmana**, **Shatrughna** and **Sita** gather close around them, moved and tearful. Surroundings: the leafy hermitage, flowering trees, gentle deer, soft golden light filtering through the canopy, an atmosphere thick with love and grief. Emotions: love, joy, heartbreak, brotherhood. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with deeply expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft warm gradients, detailed robes and forest, lush atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; rich saturated colours (saffron-emerald-amber-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 23: "Come Home and Rule"

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Bharata fell at Rama's feet and pleaded with all his heart. "Brother, please come home and be our king — the throne is rightfully yours!" Everyone hoped Rama would agree and end the long, sad exile.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A moving, earnest forest scene. Noble **Bharata** kneels humbly at **Rama's** feet, both hands raised in heartfelt pleading, his face full of love and longing; **Rama** stands calm and compassionate, gently lifting his brother. Around them, the queen-mothers, sages and ministers watch with hopeful, tearful faces. Surroundings: the hermitage clearing, soft beams of light, drifting petals, an air of tender appeal. Emotions: pleading love, hope, compassion. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook

illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed robes, lush atmospheric forest depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-green-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 24: Rama's Steadfast Promise

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

But Rama gently shook his head. "I gave our father my word to stay in the forest for fourteen years, and I must keep it," he said. "A promise is sacred, dear brother." His honour and his duty would not be moved, even by love.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A serene, noble forest scene with soft radiant light around Rama. **Rama** stands calm and resolute, one hand raised gently and the other on his heart, his face full of quiet conviction and love as he explains his vow; **Bharata** and the others listen with respectful, moved, accepting expressions. Surroundings: the hermitage clearing, a soft halo of light on Rama, towering trees, gentle deer, a dignified peaceful mood. Emotions: steadfastness, honour, gentle resolve, respect. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft luminous gradients, detailed robes and forest, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow on Rama; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-emerald-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 25: The Sacred Sandals

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Then Bharata had a loving idea. "If you will not come, give me your sandals," he said. "I will place them upon the throne, and rule only as your humble servant until you return." Rama smiled and gave Bharata his golden sandals.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A touching, solemn forest moment bathed in warm light. **Rama** gently hands his pair of simple golden wooden **sandals (paduka)** to **Bharata**, who receives them reverently with both hands lifted to his bowed head, tears of devotion in his eyes, as if accepting a sacred treasure. **Sita, Lakshmana** and the watching elders look on with moved, tender faces. Surroundings: the hermitage clearing, soft glowing light on the sandals, drifting petals, a reverent hush. Emotions: devotion, humility, brotherly love, sacredness. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with expressive faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft glowing gradients, detailed sandals and robes, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with radiant rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-gold-emerald). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 26: Ruling in Rama's Name

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Bharata carried the sandals home and placed them gently upon the royal throne of Ayodhya. He himself lived simply, like a hermit, in a small town called Nandigrama. There he ruled faithfully, always waiting and longing for his brother's return.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A reverent, heartfelt scene in a modest hall. Devoted **Bharata**, dressed in simple ascetic robes with matted hair, kneels before a royal throne upon which rest **Rama's golden sandals**, honouring them with folded hands, a lamp and flowers, ruling humbly in his brother's name. Surroundings: a simple dignified hall in Nandigrama, the empty crowned throne holding only the sandals, soft devotional light, garlands. Emotions: devotion, humility, faithful waiting, love. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized character, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft glowing gradients, detailed throne and sandals, atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm devotional cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (saffron-gold-cream). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 27: Moving Deeper into the Wild

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

After Bharata returned home, the holy sages of Chitrakuta grew worried about wandering demons. So Rama, Sita, and Lakshmana decided to journey on, deeper into the great forests. With brave hearts, they set off toward new and unknown lands.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A scene of departure into deeper wilderness in warm late-afternoon light. **Rama** (bow ready), **Sita** and **Lakshmana** walk along a winding forest trail leaving the Chitrakuta hermitage behind, gazing forward with calm, brave faces toward dense green woodland and distant blue hills. Surroundings: towering ancient trees, thickening forest, a glowing trail of light ahead, watchful deer and birds, a sense of new adventure. Emotions: courage, resolve, gentle anticipation. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft gradients, detailed forest and robes, lush atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (emerald-saffron-turquoise-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 28: The Hermitage of Sage Atri

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Along the way they reached the peaceful hermitage of the great sage Atri and his gentle, holy wife Anasuya. The kind old couple welcomed the travellers warmly and blessed them. Wise Anasuya was especially delighted to meet the devoted Sita.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A serene, glowing hermitage scene in soft golden light. The aged sage **Atri** (white beard, saffron robes, radiant aura) and his gentle, luminous wife **Anasuya** (kind wrinkled face, simple white-and-cream robes, soft halo) warmly welcome **Rama**, **Sita** and **Lakshmana** with blessings and folded hands; Anasuya gazes lovingly at Sita. Surroundings: a tranquil ashram, sacred fire, blossoming trees, deer, lotus pond, soft sacred light. Emotions: warmth, reverence, gentle affection. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with warm faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft glowing gradients, detailed hermitage and robes, lush atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (emerald-cream-saffron-gold). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 29: Anasuya's Loving Gifts

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Holy Anasuya gave Sita beautiful garlands, fragrant oils, and a magical dress and jewels that would never fade. She praised Sita for her faithfulness and pure, loving heart. Sita thanked her with a gentle, grateful bow.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A tender, intimate scene inside the sage's hermitage in warm soft light. The luminous elderly ascetic **Anasuya** lovingly gives gentle **Sita** a glowing magical garland, a shimmering never-fading dress, and sparkling ornaments, her wrinkled face full of blessing; **Sita** receives them with a graceful, grateful bow and shining eyes. Surroundings: a cosy ashram interior, soft lamplight, flowers, a sacred glow on the gifts, a loving mood. Emotions: blessing, gratitude, gentle reverence, warmth. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters with warm faces, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft glowing gradients, detailed garments and gifts, intimate atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (rose-saffron-gold-cream). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

Page 30: Onward into the Forest

STORY TEXT FOR KIDS

Blessed by the holy sages, Rama, Sita, and Lakshmana walked bravely onward into the deep, mysterious forest. Many adventures still lay ahead of them in the wild green world. And so, hand in hand and full of courage, the next part of their great journey began.

AI IMAGE PROMPT

A hopeful, story-bridging scene at golden hour. **Rama, Sita** and **Lakshmana**, blessed and serene, walk together down a sun-dappled forest path toward a glowing horizon of deep green woodland and distant blue hills, their backs partly to us, faces lifted with calm courage. Surroundings: towering trees arching overhead, shafts of warm light, flowers and gentle wildlife along the trail, a sense of unfolding adventure ahead. Emotions: courage, togetherness, hope, the promise of more to come. **Art style:** richly detailed digital children's-storybook illustration like a modern *Illustrated Ramayana for Children* cover — semi-realistic softly stylized characters, polished digital painting, gentle cel-shading, soft luminous gradients, detailed forest and robes, lush sweeping atmospheric depth with soft focus, warm golden-hour cinematic light with gentle rim-glow; vibrant saturated colours (emerald-saffron-gold-turquoise). Full-bleed, edge-to-edge, **no border, no frame**; aspect ratio 4:3.

The End of Ayodhya Kanda

*This completes Book Two of the Ramayana — the **Ayodhya Kanda** ("The Book of Ayodhya") — retold in 30 chronological pages, faithfully preserving its core events and moral depth: the joyful plan to crown Rama, Manthara's jealous scheming, Kaikeyi's two boons, Rama's calm acceptance of exile, the devotion of Sita and Lakshmana, the sorrowful farewell, the kindness of Guha, the death of heartbroken King Dasaratha, Bharata's noble refusal of the throne, the reunion at Chitrakuta, Rama's steadfast vow, the sacred sandals upon the throne, and the blessings of Atri and Anasuya — woven throughout with gentle lessons of **keeping one's promise, honouring one's parents, duty before comfort, selfless love, and the harm done by jealousy and bad advice.***

Tips for consistent illustrations:

1. Generate **Page 1 first**, then reuse its renderings of Rama, Sita and Lakshmana (royal at first, then in saffron exile dress) as a style/character reference; do the same for **Bharata, Dasaratha and Kaikeyi**.
2. Keep the **Master Style Block** and **Character Reference Sheet** pasted at the top of every prompt.
3. Use the same **aspect ratio (4:3)** and the "**digital children's-book illustration ... full-bleed, no border, no frame**" keywords on every page so this book matches the rest of the series.
4. This is a tender, emotional book — keep grief scenes **gentle and dignified**, leaning on warm light and loving expressions so it stays comforting and kid-friendly.